

NICOLAUS COPERNICUS

1473–1543

DATA FILE



KEY ACHIEVEMENT: Discovered that Earth orbited the Sun



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: Poland



YEAR OF ACHIEVEMENT: 1543



Copernican model showing the planets orbiting the Sun

Copernicus was a canon at Frombork Cathedral, in modern-day Poland.

By the 16th century, Europe had become the centre of scientific knowledge. In 1543, Copernicus concluded that the planets circled the Sun, not Earth. This was a revolutionary and dangerous idea that contradicted the Church's view that Earth was stationary at the centre of the Universe.